

the wake of her death, being on hold with the bank and then waiting in endless lines. He only sort of knew beforehand that he was the executor of her estate, because when she got sick, Steve didn't want to spend her last months talking about what he'd do without her. He said he regrets it now, but part of him felt that it was the job of the person who was dying to bring it up. He also understands that accepting that you're dying is a huge emotional journey so he wants to cut his mother some slack. (Super fair.)

On top of grieving his loss when she passed, he felt kicked while he was down by all the bureaucracy and minutia. Her funeral, which cost nearly \$12,000, required flowers, an urn, printed photos of her to use, a card with a quote, and many other choices. (None of this was specified in her will. It's just what Steve wanted to do to celebrate her.) For a wedding, you spend a year and a half planning a fun party, but after someone dies, Steve said, "You're spending two days while you're sad as shit planning a very, very sad party."

Paying off his mother's debts cost him \$30,000 to \$35,000. "I guess I thought before this, a lot of little bills would just go away— like, 'Oh, they died; that's sad. You get a pass.'" This was not the case. "A bunch of little bullshit bills," he called them. His mother had American Express points that he just let go. It was too much trouble to get a death certificate and prove that he was the executor. He could also get them only in gift cards. "It was just like the most ridiculous thing, and it was at the tail end, and I was just like, fuck it, I don't care. I just don't."

Eden inherited her parents' house—her childhood home, where she still lives today. She pays the mortgage on it. When I went there to tape a podcast in 2016, she was still surrounded by their things: closets of their clothes, their art hanging on the walls, their furniture in the living room. Part of her wants to do something with all of it, but part of her still feels too overwhelmed.

Writer Rob Penty wrote in a *Billfold* article, "What I Learned about Money after My Parents Died," about inheriting a home and money from his parents, who passed away within six months of each other. Penty said everyone expected him to have become an heir to a fortune. (His roommate immediately asked if they could get a new TV.)